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Introduction to Business Frameworks

22nd August, 2026

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Introduction - Hi! I am Pranjal Bangani

- Work extensively with Mesa as a Professor and Mentor from C1
- General Manager, Strategy at Swiggy Instamart
- Ex-Management Consultant at Boston Consulting Group & Bain & Co.
    - 8 cases across Financial Services, Industrial Goods, Tech, Media & Telecom (TMT) clients
- Alumni of IIM Lucknow (Majors in Finance & Strategy) and IIT Bhubaneswar
- Very passionate about startups, investing, teaching and football
- Been in Bangalore, Mumbai & Pune most of my life

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Agenda

1 Your approach to the cases

2 Discussion on how we can refine our solutions



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Course Ground Rules

- We start on time, and we end on time
- We've kept the classes short - will prefer not breaking the flow midway
- No usage of mobile phones in the class
- Share your thoughts by first raising your hands
- We respect the person discussing their thoughts by maintaining silence
- A basic average answer you've thought of by yourself >>> Refined AI slop
- Taking notes is highly highly recommended :)

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So let’s get right into it!

You are the CEO of Wow! Momo FMCG. You have capital for one major category bet. What do you do?

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You are the CEO of Wow! Momo FMCG. You have capital for one major category bet. What do you do?

A. Double down on frozen momos

B. Double down on ambient noodles

C. Enter ready-to-eat meals

D. Enter an entirely new convenience-food category

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You are the CEO of Wow! Momo FMCG. You have capital for one major category bet. What do you do?

"What would have to be true for your answer to be correct?"

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Wow! Faces 2 clear realities in the face of well-capitalized competition

Frozen

- Strong adjacency
- Operationally expensive
- Limited freezer space
- Intensifying competition

Ambient

- Easier distribution
- Lower incremental logistics cost
- Easier general-trade expansion
- Potentially broader category expansion

"What is the strongest signal in the case that the company's future may not simply be frozen momos?"

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To solve this, let’s start from the basics

What business is Wow! Momo actually in?

- "We sell momos."
- "We sell Asian food."
- "We solve convenient, exciting meal and snack occasions."
- None of the above

What business is Wow! Momo actually in?

Fun, flavour-forward, convenient Asian-inspired food for Indian consumers.

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With this in mind, should Wow! Momo only defend frozen momos?

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2 options - Should Wow! Momo only defend frozen momos?

Defend Frozen aggressively

- Core category
- Highest brand authenticity
- Strong consumer association
- Existing know-how
- Abandoning leadership creates competitor advantage

Redirect resources

- Freezer facings are constrained
- Cost to serve is higher
- ITC-backed competition increases capital intensity
- Ambient has shown strong traction
- Distribution economics may be structurally superior

Strategically important but not deserving of unlimited investment. Hence, Defend the core; don't necessarily bet the future exclusively on the core.

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So how should Wow! Momo choose a new category?

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Major decisioning factors include

- Consumer occasion attractiveness
- Frequency potential
- Wow! Momo brand permission
- Distribution fit
- Unit economics potential
- Competitive intensity
- Ability to compound existing assets
- Cannibalisation risk
- Execution complexity
- 3-year scalability

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An attractive category is not automatically an attractive strategic choice for Wow! Momo.

The right question to ask here is

Why should Wow! Momo win here when other companies cannot?

Essentially, what is Wow!’s right-to-win - the opportunity where the brand, channel and supply chain advantages intersect.

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What would make this strategy fail even if consumers like the product?

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We need to think about Compounding growth here

- Does every SKU create additional fixed complexity?
- Does every category require separate trade relationships?
- Does each new product require new manufacturing capability?
- Does it dilute management attention?
- Does it improve distribution economics?
- Does success in one product make the next product easier to sell?

Existing asset → makes next expansion easier → increases asset value → enables another expansion

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What assets does Wow! have that it can leverage & compound?

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What is cannibalization? Is there such a thing as good cannibalization?

- Existing customer - ₹300 restaurant order → Replaces it with ₹80 packaged product
  - Company loses contribution margin AND doesn't gain a new Cx or occasion
- Consumer previously ordered from a competing food brand.
  - Wow! Momo packaged product captures the occasion, OR
  - The consumer would not have visited the restaurant anyway, OR
  - The packaged product serves a different geography or time of day.

Are we cannibalising ourselves, or preventing a competitor from owning the adjacent occasion?

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Forming a POV on costs to ascertain Unit Economics

What are the various fixed and variable costs that Wow! Momos incurs?

- Manufacturing cost
- Packaging
- Transportation
- Cold-chain cost where applicable
- Trade margin
- Platform commission
- Listing fees
- Promotional discounts
- Returns
- Wastage

"Which of these costs improve with scale?"
"Which remain structurally high?"
"Which are different across frozen and ambient?"

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Scalability - How do we go from ₹100 Crore ARR to ₹500 Crore

The case gives 4 broad growth levers:

- More SKUs
- More channels
- More geographies
- Exports

Each of them come with their own Pros & Cons

"Which of these creates the strongest flywheel?"

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My Reco - Double down on ambient convenience meals & noodles, while selectively defending frozen momos

Use the momo brand as an entry point into a broader convenience-food platform, with ambient products becoming the primary scaling engine.

- Evidence of consumer traction already exists
- Ambient improves distribution economics
- It reduces dependence on scarce freezer capacity
- It allows Wow! Momo to avoid a purely defensive battle
- The strategy can compound using a potential flywheel - Successful noodles → Retailer confidence → More shelf access → More ambient SKUs → Higher distribution density → Better trade economics → More consumer trials → Stronger convenience-food positioning *(much more scalable than repeatedly fighting for freezer capacity)*

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Homework - “Food” for thought

Using this strategy as a base, think about

- Why should Wow! not simply just launch more momo variants or noodle products?
- Does ITC entering through Prasuma mean Wow! Momo should exit frozen momos?
- What does "brand permission" actually mean?
- What is more important: TAM or distribution economics?
- What evidence in the first 90 days would prove the strategy wrong?
- What assumption would you most want to test before committing capital?
- If you were the CEO, what would you stop doing?

What did you make of the Xoxoday case?

“We are acquiring many customers. Why is revenue going down, and what should we do?”

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Revenue is the output of a system. New customer acquisition is only one input into that system.

A company can simultaneously:

- acquire more customers,
- close more deals,
- generate more leads,
- have busy sales teams,

Mindset shift from *“Are we growing?”* to
“What kind of growth are we creating, how much revenue does it generate, and does it persist and expand?”

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Revenue Growth is a function of New Revenue + Expansion - Contraction - Churn

Revenue contraction despite increasing logos gives rise to 3 hypothesis:

- H1: New customers are lower quality
  - Small companies, Low ACV, Low willingness to pay, High churn, Low expansion
- H2: Existing customers are deteriorating
  - Churn, Revenue contraction, Reduced usage, Competitive switching, Weak customer success
- H3: GTM economics have become misaligned
  - Marketing optimized for volume, Sales optimized for speed, Product optimized for standardization, Business now needs larger, more complex customers

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Critical to distinguish activity metrics from business outcomes

Activity / input metrics

- Leads
- Website traffic
- Demo volume
- Sales calls
- Number of new logos
- Deals closed

Economic outcomes

- Revenue
- ARR/MRR
- Revenue retention
- Net revenue retention
- Customer lifetime value
- Gross margin
- Contribution from expansion

A metric is useful only if it has a credible relationship with the economic outcome the company is trying to optimize.

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Logo segmentation is critical - WHO are the 70 logos we've onboarded?

Customers differ dramatically

- company size,
- spending capacity,
- number of users,
- use cases (products they buy)
- implementation complexity,
- retention probability,
- expansion potential,
- acquisition channel & cost,
- sales cycle.

Metrics need segmentation to become diagnostic.

Cohort quality matters more than cumulative customer count.

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Is sales optimized for adding logos, instead of revenue growth?

Elements of the sales cycle have to be aligned for revenue-growth vs volume-growth

- Marketing
- Lead generation
- Customer segment
- Sales motion
- Product architecture
- Onboarding
- Customer success
- Retention and expansion
- Revenue

If Xoxoday's GTM engine increasingly attracts small customers, then they may be becoming very efficient at acquiring customers who generate relatively little revenue.

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If Xoxoday's GTM engine increasingly attracts small customers, then they may be becoming very efficient at acquiring customers with low-friction, even if they generate relatively little revenue.

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Design a CEO Dashboard

Given the case context, what are the top 10 metrics you will choose for a CEO dashboard?

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Thank you!

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